



Verizon Galaxy S22 Ultra

Verizon Galaxy S22 Ultra pricing tipped by a rep along with first-hand impressions
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tech

FEATURE

users' information to a command-and-control (C&C) server. These credentials are then sold on black markets and/or used to create accounts on other trading platforms.

c) Malware:

There are multiple types of malware utilised by hackers to steal cryptocurrency from a number of sources.

i) **Mining Malware:** Unlike common currency, of which more can always be printed, there exists only a finite number of any one given cryptocurrency. Crypto mining therefore, is an extremely intensive task, in terms of computation as well as power consumption. Mining malware commonly targets those computers, or nodes in the blockchain which have mined cryptocurrency, and steals their resources from the crypto wallet address stored in their memory.

ii) **Memory-changing Malware:** This malware, when installed on a user's machine, can change the cryptocurrency exchange or the user's wallet to that of the attacker's.

iii) **Fake Tools:** Malware is also released into user's computers in the form of fake tools. These fake tools are most often featured in advertisements hosted on legitimate cryptocurrency trading platforms. An example of this is arbitrage calculators designed to help investors devise strategies with regards to cryptocurrency. However, the calculator contains a script in its code which installs malware in the investor's computer, and leeches the address of the

investor's crypto wallet stored in the system's memory.

d) Trading Bots:

A fourth tool to execute cryptocurrency theft is trading bots. They are extremely popular with crypto users, as they allow for an entirely automated trading process and require little to no user engagement. However, malware is extremely easy to disguise as trading bots, which subsequently infects a device with coin miners, which then steal the cryptocurrency from the wallet address stored in the device's memory.

HOW CAN YOU PROTECT YOUR INVESTMENT?

Investors can utilize multiple methods to protect their cryptocurrency-

i) The first is to make use of 'Cold' crypto wallets as compared to 'Hot' wallets. The latter refers to web-based mobile or desktop crypto wallets which are connected to the internet at all times. Their benefit lies in their ease of use since they are always online. However, this also makes them much more susceptible to online attacks in the form of malicious tools. Cold wallets, in contrast, are much more secure. Stealing from them requires physical access to the same, as well as any passwords they may be protected by, since they are not connected to the internet. Cold wallets are commonly in the form of hardware wallets, and look similar to small USB sticks/pen drives. Another option to store crypto is also on a secondary computer,

not connected to the internet.

ii) The second safeguard against thefts is a Two-Factor Authentication, This refers to a layer of security, in which, in addition to a username and password combo, a user will also be required to provide some information to which only they have access/known only to them- such as an answer to a secret question, a personal identification number etc. Alternatively, a user may also be asked to provide information such as a software token, a sign in authentication via their smartphones etc

iii) Users must ensure they double check website URLs to avoid phishing campaigns. Many scammers create fake websites which mirror real cryptocurrency exchange platforms but are in essence, designed to steal user information.

iv) In addition to two-factor authentication a user must also ensure that their password is of at least 16 characters which includes a mix of alphabets, symbols, as well as numbers such that it is not easy to crack. Cryptocurrency, owing to its decentralised nature, may at times prove to be a risky investment. Furthermore, one must also bear in mind that unlike conventional financial frauds, cryptocurrency thefts are extremely difficult to investigate, and hackers/scammers are far more difficult to track down. It is by no means an absolutely foolproof system, and one must therefore carry out meticulous research about the same before investing, and take rigorous steps to safeguard their investments. **d**

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